

**Top turret**
Operated by the flight engineer, the hydraulically powered top gun turret could sweep the sky in a full circle.



**Machine-gun**
The B-17 was equipped with 0.5in Browning machine-guns, a ubiquitous American weapon of World War II. Here it is mounted in the waist window.



**Cheek gun**
This 0.5in Browning is one of the flexible cheek guns that were sometimes mounted on each side of the Plexiglass nose. It was operated by the navigator.




**Constant manufacture**
A B-17 flies over Europe in 1945. For every one of the aircraft shot down by the Germans during the war, two more were produced by US factories. For this reason there were more B-17s in service during the last months of the war than at any time previously.



**Strong wheels**
Hydraulic suspension helped the undercarriage take the strain of operational flying.



**Sperry ball turret**
The Sperry ball turret could swivel 360 degrees horizontally and 90 degrees vertically. It was suspended on a gimbal from a tube attached to the fuselage ceiling.



**Aluminium skin**
The fuselage was made of aluminium alloy rings fastened with longitudinal aluminium strips and covered with an aluminium skin.